



AP 2-D Art and Design Portfolio

Aishwarya Kumaran

WV8Z7046

2026

Written Evidence

Sustained Investigation

Identify the inquiry that guided your sustained investigation.

Response:

I began by exploring how handmade creations emotionally differ from mass-produced replicas, using saturation, contrast, and layering to show how commodification alters meaning. As I progressed, I depicted hands, collaboration, and intergenerational teaching to show how the process of making itself resists commodified convenience. In this investigation, I examine the complex relationship between commodified systems and authentic creation, showing how we bring new meaning to superficial items and create not to compete with what's out there, but because the act of making is where meaning lies.

Describe ways your sustained investigation developed through practice, experimentation, and revision.

Response:

I practiced showing contrast between handmade and commodified through saturation and layering by juxtaposing homemade and store-bought items and placing handmade beneath/sitting-above a commodified barrier (#1-5,11). I revised my approach to focus on making itself, zooming in on hands and collaborative labor (#6-8,14-15). I experimented with materials, collaging old valentines, poster fabrics, dough, and novel pages to evoke the tangibility of handmade (#1-2,7-9), and complexity showing how commodified items accumulate personal meaning depending on who makes, gives, or receives them (#9-13).



Image 1

Sustained Investigation

Height: 10

Width: 12.5

Depth: 0

Materials:

Acrylic paint, my old store-bought valentines from kindergarten, origami hearts

Process(es):

Collaged valentines surrounding subject to show being surrounded by mass-produced gifts/society

Use of Digital Tool(s): Yes

Digital Tool(s) used:

Canva for graphic overlays (background shadow on top right panel). Rest was arranged physically.

Image 2

Sustained Investigation

Height: N/A

Width: N/A

Materials:

Sketchbook, acrylic paint, my old store-bought valentines from kindergarten, origami hearts

Process(es):

Process photo of SI #1 ideation and thinking

Use of Digital Tool(s): Yes

Digital Tool(s) used:

Figma for arranging grid layout



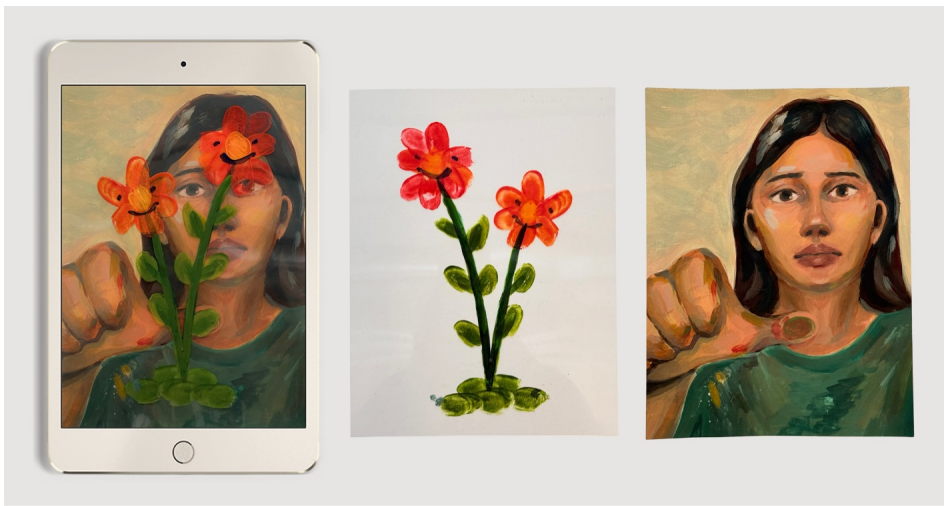


Image 3

Sustained Investigation

Height: 10

Width: 20

Depth: 0

Materials: Acrylic paint, plastic film, iPad

Process(es):

Fingerprints to make flower. Layered
above girl in iPad. Juxtaposes
fingerprints' societal/human use

Use of Digital Tool(s): Yes

Digital Tool(s) used:

Used Canva for image grid layout, iPad
for staging

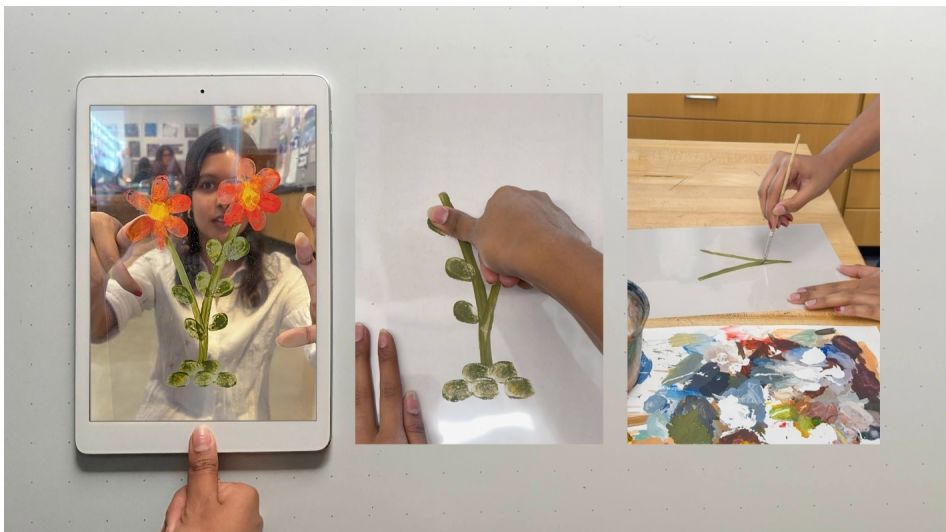


Image 4

Sustained Investigation

Height: 13.5

Width: 27

Materials:

Acrylic paint, plastic film, iPad,
whiteboard base

Process(es):

Recreated SI #3, but I am the subject,
used window to replicate stamping, and
real iPad for framing

Use of Digital Tool(s): Yes

Digital Tool(s) used:

Canva used to layer the images side by
side and above iPad



Image 5

Sustained Investigation

Height: 11

Width: 14

Materials: Acrylic paint

Process(es):

Hiding the cookie in packaged layers as

I progressed rightwards to show

homemade to mass produced

Use of Digital Tool(s): No



Image 6

Sustained Investigation

Height: 11

Width: 14

Depth: 0

Materials: Acrylic paint

Process(es):

Vibrant colors evoke childhood
nostalgia. Multiple kids working to show
collaboration

Use of Digital Tool(s): No



Image 7

Sustained Investigation

Height: 9.5

Width: 8.5

Depth: 0

Materials:

Cardboard, craft paint, canvas fabric,
craft marker

Process(es):

Collaged materials with hand photos I
took. Emphasizes hands and making
collaboratively

Use of Digital Tool(s): Yes

Digital Tool(s) used:

Canva to overlay the individual photos



Image 8

Sustained Investigation

Height: 14

Width: 10

Materials:

Acrylic paint, old worn paper to give vintage feel, dough

Process(es):

Family dough recipe; dough smeared on table top/hands to show learning passed down

Use of Digital Tool(s): No



Image 9

Sustained Investigation

Height: 9

Width: 12

Materials:

Acrylic paint, ripped pages from novels

Process(es):

Applied ripped pages to surroundings, heart, hand, and library to show giving away pieces of oneself

Use of Digital Tool(s): No



Image 10

Sustained Investigation

Height: 9

Width: 12

Materials: Acrylic paint, color pencil

Process(es):

Whimsical detail on cranes and ocean to show uncertainty of giving while not knowing the destination

Use of Digital Tool(s): No

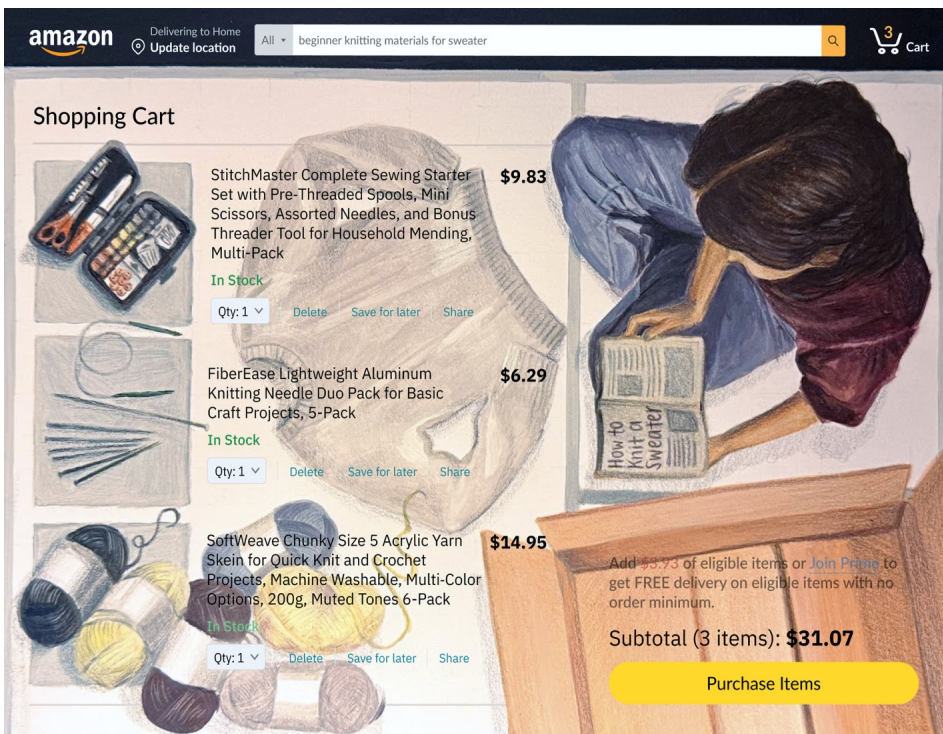


Image 11

Sustained Investigation

Height: 11

Width: 14

Materials: Color pencil, acrylic paint

Process(es):

Created Amazon shopping cart page, layered scene to show buying materials to make something original

Use of Digital Tool(s): Yes

Digital Tool(s) used:

Figma to create Amazon website elements like header, text, buttons, and final layered composition.

Citation(s):

Amazon.com shopping cart page



Image 12

Sustained Investigation

Height: 8.5

Width: 13.5

Materials: Acrylic paint

Process(es):

Took picture of favorite bakery. Painted cake copies to show commodification/products people can buy

Use of Digital Tool(s): No



Image 13

Sustained Investigation

Height: 9

Width: 13

Materials:

Cake cut-outs from SI #12, past birthday photos, photo album, ruler with age progression

Process(es):

Adhered cut-outs to old photos (same bakery cake) to show each copy brings joy to a unique occasion

Use of Digital Tool(s): Yes

Digital Tool(s) used:

Used Canva design tools to hide some numbers on the ruler (intentional for piece's meaning)



Image 14

Sustained Investigation

Height: 18

Width: 24

Depth: 0.5

Materials: Acrylic paint, canvas

Process(es):

Photo of my school garden. Emphasis on making, hands, people, and nature via vibrant colors/contrast

Use of Digital Tool(s): No



Image 15

Sustained Investigation

Height: 18

Width: 24

Materials:

SI #14 painting, photo of same scene 1 year later

Process(es):

Overlaid photo of current garden to show the bountiful result of hand-made collaboration over time

Use of Digital Tool(s): Yes

Digital Tool(s) used:

Used Figma to overlay and arrange in grid



Work 1

Selected Works

Height: 11

Width: 14

Idea(s):

As goods are commodified, the authentic original hides behind branding and packaging.

Materials: Acrylic paint

Process(es):

Hiding the cookie in packaged layers as

I progressed rightwards to show

homemade to mass produced

Use of Digital Tool(s): No



Work 2

Selected Works

Height: 10

Width: 12.5

Idea(s):

Surrounded by the mass-produced, she finds meaning only in what she made herself.

Materials:

Acrylic paint, my old store-bought valentines from kindergarten, origami hearts

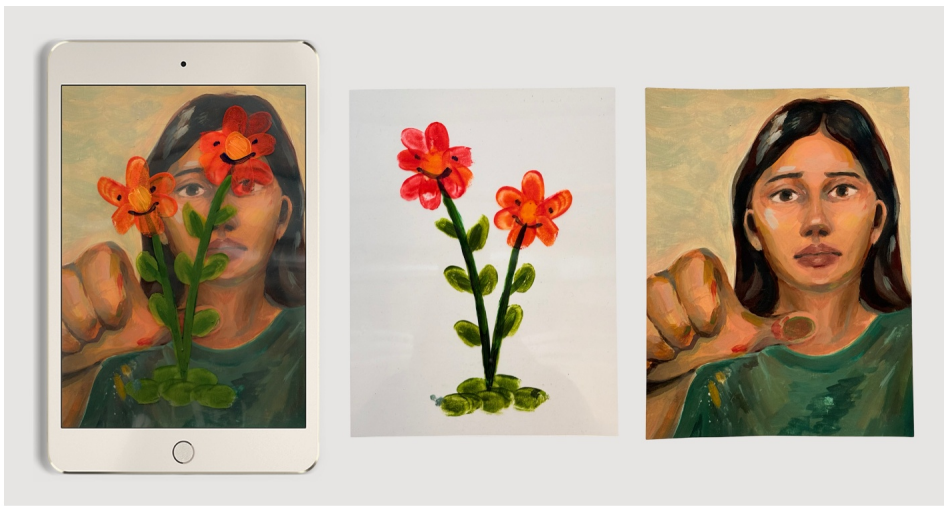
Process(es):

Collaged valentines surrounding subject to show being surrounded by mass-produced gifts/society

Use of Digital Tool(s): Yes

Digital Tool(s) used:

Canva for graphic overlays (background shadow on top right panel). Rest was arranged physically.



Work 3

Selected Works

Height: 10

Width: 20

Idea(s):

Commodification redefines our human markings, as what once expressed identity is now locked away.

Materials: Acrylic paint, plastic film

Process(es):

Fingerprints to make flower. Layered above girl in iPad. Juxtaposes fingerprints' societal/human use

Use of Digital Tool(s): Yes

Digital Tool(s) used:

Used Canva free graphics (provided with school subscription) to use iPad for staging



Work 4

Selected Works

Height: 14

Width: 10

Idea(s):

Passed down skills are lost to commodified convenience, hindering connection and knowledge sharing.

Materials: Acrylic paint, old worn paper

Process(es):

Family dough recipe; dough smeared on table top/hands to show learning passed down

Use of Digital Tool(s): No



Work 5

Selected Works

Height: 18

Width: 24

Idea(s):

In a cutthroat system, collaborative hands grew the most living, abundant space in the school.

Materials: Acrylic paint, canvas

Process(es):

Photo of my school garden. Emphasis on making, hands, people, and nature via vibrant colors/contrast

Use of Digital Tool(s): No